LING 431/531 Gitksan Glossed Data

Group F - Andrew, Matthias, Zahra

Field Methods 2026W1

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1 Elicitation 2026.09.24

Date: 2026.09.24
Consultant: Hector Hill / Gy'ax
Elicitors: Zahra, Andrew
Location: TFS elicitation room
Context: First elicitation for LING 431/531 Field Methods
Audio: `September_25_2026_HH.WAV`

1.1 [0:00-14:30]

[4:30]: Discussion of the pronunciation of *we'y*/*wa'y* – after the glottal is a bit hard to hear but sounds like the unvoiced vowel that Henry had mentioned.

[4:45]: Not positive that suffix is *'y*. maybe an allomorph thereof? Note for [4:55] also applies here, as in `https://www.firstvoices.com/gitsenimx/search?q=anookii%27y&domain=both&types=word%2Cphrase%2Csong%2Cstory`.

Note from the future: the *g* in *anoogi'y* sometimes sounds like a *x*. This is especially clear at [7:32], where Hector pronounces it both ways back to back. [Z: also hearing a bit of labialization on this consonant possibly; but not on the root in isolation as in 5:23.]

(1) anoogi'y
anook-i-'y
like-TR-1SG.II
'I like ...'

[4:55]: There is one entry in first voices of *ekstedinii'y* 'I like...' (`https://www.firstvoices.com/gitsenimx/search?q=ekstedinii%27y&domain=both&types=word%2Cphrase%2Csong%2Cstory`).

Some digging reveals that this *ii* is what Henry's grammar (sec. 3.3.2, p. 44) describes as a **transitive vowel**, which is present only with independent transitive verbs, acting as a "inflectional marker of transitivity". Whether this should be written as one vowel (as Henry glosses it) or two (as in the dictionary) I am not sure. I tentatively choose the former.

(2) ekstedini'y (anaax) tun
ekstedin-i-'y (anaax) tun
like-TR-1SG.II (bread) this
'I like this (bread)'

[5:10]:

(3) anoogi'y 'nisi'm
anook-i-'y 'nisi'm
like-TR-1SG.II 2PL.III
'I like you guys'

[5:23]: *anook* also means 'let/allow'.

(4) anoogi'y dim yeen
anook-i-'y dim yee-n
allow-TR-1SG.II PROSP walk-2SG.II
'I let you go/leave'

[5:27]:

(5) anoogi'y 'niin
anook-i-'y 'niin
like-TR-1SG.II 2SG.III
'I like you'

[5:33]: I very strongly hear a *d* after *siipin*. While *siipin* is not included in the brief lists of Big-T verbs in Rigsby (1986:340) or Hunt (1993:237), I see no other explanation for this, since the root is pretty clearly *siipin*. May want to ask Michael about this.

Consultant comment: refers to *siipintxw* 'lover/friend' (see [5:53]).

(6) siipin-d-i-'y 'niin
siipin-t-i-'y 'niin
like-T-TR-1SG.II 2SG.III
'I like/love you'

[5:53]: I assume *en-* is the Gigeenix version of nominalizer *an-* in Henry's grammar (sec. 2.2.3.2, p. 5). Hector translates *en-* as 'my', but I could find absolutely no indication of a prenominal possessive with this form. If anything, there is a possessive use of *-(t)xw* mentioned in Henry's grammar (p. 3, fn 3). I don't know what to make of this, but I don't want to write off Hector's intuitions.

Hector also mentions that *ensiipintxw* is difficult to translate to English, as it spans multiple uses.

(7) ensiipintxw
en-siipin-txw
NMLZ-love-VAL
'My(?) friend/lover'

[Z: ∧ I think I do hear the voiceless -'y suffix here, hence the 'my' (and I think that's right about the NMLZ).]

[7:38]: This is extremely difficult for me to transcribe. The sentence is 'I like what you guys are doing (with Gitksan)'. Two things are fairly certain: (1) this contains a headless RC (at least per the translation) (2) it uses a Series II subject suffix *-si'm*, which is characteristic of object extraction (Henry sec. 4.3.3.3, p. 81). To address (1), I chose to include a *=hl*, which can select a RC as per Henry's grammar (p.50). What's problematic is that the only potential *=hl* I hear is after the embedded predicate *yuk* 'to do smthng', while it normally appears before the predicate from which the subject was extracted (cf. ex (107) in Henry's grammar). What's more, *=hl* is a clitic, so it makes no sense that the *-si'm* suffix would follow it. I also don't hear the full pronoun *'nisi'm* here.

Tldr; this transcription is definitely wrong, but I don't know what the correct one is.

(8) anoogi'y yuhlsi'm (ihl gitksenimx̲)
anook-i-'y yuk-hl-si'm (ihl gitksenimx̲)
like-TR-1SG.II do-CN-2PL.II (for Gitksenimx̲)
'I like what you guys are doing (with/for the Gitksan language)'

[7:53]: Andrew's sentence, confirmed by Hector. Couldn't figure out what *genu* means, but *hloxsa genu gwiikw* is a compound meaning September, literally 'month when the groundhogs get ready for winter' (see First Voices).

At [8:25] Hector translates *hloxsa* as 'month of'. I don't attempt to break the compound down, but the *a* in *hloxsa* could potentially be an attributive marker (ATTR). Henry's grammar (sec. 2.2.4.1, p.8) claims that ATTR can only appear on adjectives, whereas *hloxs* looks like a noun. However, on p. 3, Henry also says "The attributive suffix *-m/-a* which links modifiers to their modifiees can also attach to nouns (since nouns can modify other nouns)", so there is an inconsistency here.

(9) anoogi'y hloxsa genu gwiikw
anook-i-'y hloxsa genu gwiikw
like-TR-1SG.II month ??? groundhog
'I like September [=the month when the groundhogs get ready for winter]'

[Scanned dictionary, p.65 : *Hloxsa gennuu gwiikw* 'September'. FV says 'month when the groundhogs get ready for winter,' with spelling *genu* as here (also in Lantz and Turner (2003) ethnobiology paper with the dictionary spelling).]

[8:45]: Hector says that *gwiikw* is also an old term for 'money', but now *dala* is used more often.

[13:42]: *legim anaax* is 'flour', but probably dry flour ([14:13] in audio). *anaax* is 'bread', I don't know what meaning *legim* contributes. [Scanned dictionary: gigeenix *lagim* / gyeets *ligem*.] Also, I assume the distinct *i* in *yelihl* is a transitive marker, but it could also be epenthesizing a vowel to avoid a *lhl* cluster?

Also, at [14:00] Hector says that "you are just saying you are mixing flour", so this likely isn't an imperative construction.

(10) yelihl legim anaax
mix-i=hl legim anaax
like-TR-CN flour
'You mix flour'

1.2 [14:30-?]

Note we don't have to keep this subsection structure, but am using it to divide transcription times for now.

1.3 [40:00-53:53]

[40:50]: **Context:** *We just finished picking berries, and we want to split it evenly to take back home.*

Is, e.g., take.PL a good way to transcribe plural predicates? Also, Henry glosses *-t* as 3.II, but I believe 3SG.II is more accurate?

(11) dim mehla dok'm sto'ot
dim mehla dok-'m sto'o-t
PROSP each take.PL-1PL.II half-3SG.II
'We'll take half each'

[41:53]: These were presented by Zahra, second and third were (audibly) confirmed by Hector, not sure about the first.

(12) a. k'i'y hlak'aphl
k'i'y hlak'ap=hl
one piece=CN
'One piece [of bread]'

b. k'eekw gax
k'eekw gax
one rabbit
'One rabbit'

c. ky'ulhl gyet
ky'ul=hl gyet
one=CN man
'One man/person'

[42:48]: *wilk'yep* shows up in numbers logically multiplied by 10 (two digit numbers and one hundred), but whether it is morphologically transparent I am not sure. It clearly contains *k'yep* 'ten', but I am unsure whether *wil-* is a morpheme or *wilk'yep* is simply lexicalized. I am also unsure how I'd gloss this, so tentatively using "-ty" (as in twen-ty, thir-ty, etc.)

(13) k'yep wilk'yep
k'yep wilk'yep
ten "-ty"
'One hundred'

[43:00]: Hector: "We don't use all those numbers, when I was growing up we were told [very unsure about this transcription, so not glossing for now] *k'eyp xbul k'ap xwsdins* 'fifteen [different animacy bases]'.

Not sure about *wildekhlxw*. First Voices writes "10 x 100 = 1000", but I don't see components of ten or one hundred in here.

(14) k'i'y wildekhlxw
k'i'y wildekhlxw
one thousand
'One thousand'

[43:24]: "And that was as far as we were told, because for us, when we say [gloss below, at 43:32] that means we're comparing. So in my family, we were never allowed to do the numbers. When I started the numbers in 2011 here to try to explain what the numbers are. When they started going past five, I was like "what's that?". Even though I heard it, we were never allowed to use it. Comparison means that you're better than, or you're looking down at others, or you put yourself down. So the numbers that you're saying, they're new to me, but to others, they're comfortable in using it. So I could say some things about numbers, but if you ask me if I use them, no."

I am not entirely sure what precedes *gupdiit*, it sounds most like *diil*, but I assume it may be focus marking (*dii*) agreeing with the embedded subject (*-t*). Examples (187), (188) in Henry's grammar both have *dii* at the object extraction site, so may be somehow systematic. The last row in `https://git-grammar.vercel.app/docs/grammar/basics/pronouns` also has a similar-looking construction.

(15) gye'a g̲abiihl diit gupdiit
gye'a g̲abii=hl dii-t gup-diit
look how.many=CN FOC-3.I eat-3PL.II
'Look at all of what they're eating.'

[45:48]: **Context (abridged)**: *Conservationists want to do a precise count of moose in the area. They come up with a number 1,312. How could we say that?*

[48:12]:

(16) k'i'y wildekhlxw x̲adaa
k'i'y wildekhlxw moose
one thousand moose
'One thousand moose'

[49:40]: Hector: "Without the *ii* you are saying one thousand one hundred, instead of saying one thousand **and** one hundred. If you put *ii* that would separate them."

This judgement is tentative. Hector is uncertain whether 1,100 is good with *ii* or not, and it is not yet clear how to actually form 1,100.

(17) k'i'y wildekhlxw k'yep wilk'yep
k'i'y wildekhlxw k'yep wilk'yep
one thousand ten "-ty"
'One thousand one hundred [=1,100]'

[52:33]: At [53:23], Hector says that when putting it this way we have to put the *ii* in it, because we are saying "one thousand and one hundred and five".

(18) k'i'y wildekhlxw k'yep wilk'yep xwsdins
k'i'y wildekhlxw k'yep wilk'yep ii xwsdins
one thousand ten "-ty" and five
'One thousand one hundred and five [=1,105]'

1.4 [53:53-end]

Ways to say 'the cat meowed' / 'the cat said meow'.

[54:10]:

(19) sdamx̲hl duus
sdamx̲-hl duus
make.noise-CN cat
'The cat meowed'. (spelling from FV gigeenix.)

[54:22]:

(20) *meow*hl duus
meow-hl duus
meow-CN cat
'The cat meowed'.

[54:28]:

(21) yukwhl algyax̲ duus
yukw=hl algyax̲ duus
PROG=CN language cat
'The cat is speaking.'

[54:36]

(22) yukwhl ayawaatxw duus
yukw=hl aya-waatxw duus
PROG=CN cry.out cat
'The cat is crying, calling out, screaming.'

[55:25]: Discussion of Gitksan sign language and its revitalization.

[57:34]: Once again hard to tell the voiceless -*'y* but it seems to be there on a close listen.

(23) 'wii'o'y 'niin
'wii'o-'y 'niin
love-1SG.II 2SG.III
'I love you.'

[58:18]: Numerals. HH didn't seem to recognize *t'ipxaat* 'two.ANIM.'

(24) ? sdamḵhl t'ipx̱aat duus
sdamḵ=hl t'ipx̱aat duus
meow=CN two.ANIM cat
Constructed (Z); intended: 'Two cats meowed'.

HH: "I think you use *bagadil* [BDM: 'two.HUM.']. Sometimes people say *gilbil* [BDM: 'two']. It depends on who is speaking … dialect, Nisga'a or Tsimshian … going to be mixed."

[59:43]:

(25) sdamḵhl bag̱adil duus
sdamḵ=hl bag̱adil duus
make.noise=CN two.HUM cat
'Two cats meowed'.

[60:43]:

(26) ? bag̱adil sdamḵhl duus
bag̱adil sdamḵ=hl duus
two.HUM make.noise=CN cat
Constructed (Z); intended: 'The cat meowed twice.'

HH: "Now you're saying that one cat meows twice." Offers instead:

[61:04]

(27) gilbil wint sdamḵhl duus tun
gilbil win-t sdamḵ=hl duus t=xʷin
two COMP=3.I make.noise=CN cat PN=DEM.PROX
'This cat meowed twice.' Comment: "That means only one cat."

Not 100% sure about *wint* here, but something like that. Doesn't sound like it's *gilba* 'twice.' Can't tell whether there are a couple more *=hl* after *gilbil* or with *win*.

[61:42]

(28) gilbil wint sdamḵhl duus dipun
gilbil win-t sdamḵ=hl duus tip=xʷin
two COMP=3.I make.noise=CN cat PN=DEM-PROX
'These two, or these three, or all these cats… all the cats meowed twice.'

HH: "Sometimes we don't use numbers, we use *dipun*, *dipus*. These, those. When we see them, then we say:"

[62:30]

(29) duus dipus
duus tip-ust
cat DEM-DIST
'all those cats'

Couldn't really hear the *t* at the end.

[62:38]

(30) da'mist g̲abi duus sdamk̲it
da'mist? g̲abi duus sdamk̲-it
how.many? CNT.AMT cat make.noise-SX
'How many cats meowed?' Comment: "You don't see them but you hear them, so you question, 'how many?'." [Check if *-hl* on *g̲abi*.]

da'mist is listed as 'how many' in FV:Gitsenimx̲; not seeing it elsewhere. Maybe involves a contracted *hinda*? Would track with e.g. *Hindahl g̲abit?* 'How many (are there)?', *Ndahl g̲abihl hapxwin?* 'How many (animals) did you trap?'. Also not hearing the *t* here. Could just be something different altogether. *g̲abi* 'how.many' is discussed in BDM. Similarly not sure if it ends in *t*.

[63:–]

(31) ga'as Hector gilbilhl duus
ga'a[-t]=s Hector gilbil=hl duus
see[3.II]=PN Hector two=CN cat
'Hector saw two cats.'

(32) bag̲adil 'nis'im
bag̲adil 'nis'im?
two ??.III?
"there's two of them"

Sounds a bit like *'nis'im* but would expect *'nidiit*?

HH: *gilbil* is animals or things.

[66:18]

(33) ga'as Hector k̲'am gilbilhl duus
ga'a[-t]=s Hector k̲'am gilbil=hl duus
see[3.II]=PN Hector only two=CN cat
'Hector only saw two cats.' Comment: "So there is more but I only seen two. People are trying to show me, but I still can't see it, because I'm fixed on the two that I like."

(34) k̲'am gilbil ga'at
k̲'am gilbil ga'a-t
only two=CN see-3.II
'only seen/seeing two' [Check if *-hl* on *gilbil*.]

2 Elicitation 2026.10.01

Date:	2026.10.01
Consultant:	Hector Hill / Gy'ax
Elicitors:	Zahra, Andrew
Location:	Second elicitation room
Context:	First elicitation for LING 431/531 Field Methods
Audio:	`October_01_2026_HH.WAV`

2.1 Matthias [0:00-35:00]

[0:43]: Found a first voices entry matching this, but I don't actually know its constituent parts. `https://www.firstvoices.com/gitsenimx/words/c3ac9f24-9731-4ea2-8290-d1b1b5e83dae`. There are a few entries using *waiy* as 'well', only found one where *woh* is also translated as 'well'.

(35) waiy woh
waiy woh
well well(?)
'Let's get started'

[1:33]: I don't actually know which part of my original prompt (*disiwilaaks 'niin*, which was ungrammatical) Hector was translating. I don't hear *ks* after *siwilaa*, instead it comes after *di-*. It makes no sense that *di-* appear where it does if this is monoclausal, but I am at a loss.

(36) siwilaa di-ks-itxw
learn di-ks-txw
learn COM-??-VAL
'Learn with someone (?)'

[2:14]: *gilbilhl smex* doesn't work without context, you have to add context, as Hector puts it "what were you doing, where did you see them, and why did you look for them".

[3:00]: This way you are still "not saying anything, there has to be some kind of accents before or after it." Hector wants to add *gya'a-'y* after.

To me, this discussion points at the fact that numerals cannot act as direct predicates of nouns to be interpreted as e.g. existential constructions. Instead, it seems that there has to be another predicating element for Hector to accept the sentence. It is possible that this is due to impoverished context, however, it seems that Hector was rejecting these outright as valid sentences.

(37) gilbil smex sapa̲gayt g̲an ?(gya'ay)
gilbil smex sapa̲gayt g̲an ?(gya'a-y)
two bear amongst tree (see-1SG.II)
'(I saw) two bears in the forest'

[3:55]: Hector doesn't use *t'ipx̲aat* as 'two'.

[5:21]: Matthias' sentence, confirmed by Hector.

(38) gya'ayhl gilbilhl smex
gya'a-y=hl gilbil=hl smex
see-1SG.II=CN two=CN bear
'I saw two bears '

[5:32]: Hector seems to drop *hl* following *gilbil*. When I said (39) with *gilbilhl*, Hector specifically repeated it dropping *=hl*.

(39) gilbil smex gya'ay
gilbil smex gya'a-y
two bear see-1SG.II
'I saw two bears '

[5:37]: Hector says that postpredicative (38) means some form of "excitment", while prepredicative (39) can be said in neutral contexts. Could this intuition point to the fact that *gya'a-y* is focused in (38)?? Hector adds phonological stress on the predicate when restating the sentence.

[7:36]:

(40) a. k'am gilbil smex gya'ay
k'am gilbil smex gya'a-y
only two bear see-1SG.II
'I saw only two bears '

b. gya'ay k'am gilbil smex
gya'a-y k'am gilbil smex
see-1SG.II only two bear
'I saw only two bears '

[8:00]: Both pre- and post-predicate *k'am* are "understandable". Depends who you're talking to…

[9:43]: Unsure about the translation of *g̲abi*. I haven't found an independent use of it yet, only seeing it in the constructions *ndahl g̲abihl* or *hindahl g̲abihl*. [10:35] seems to show that you definitely need both of the *hl*, so it would also be interesting to see where Hector systematically drops *hl*.

(41) hindehl g̲abihl smex gya'an
hinde=hl g̲abi=hl smex gya'a-n
where=CN many=CN bear see-2SG.II
'How many bears did you see?'

[11:18]: (39) is the "direct" answer to the question above. (38) is more "telling you what I've *seen*'. Can also answer with (40a).

Answering the question with simply *gilbil smex* is "not finished, but we know there's two. […] Kind of a nonchalant answer […] if he really answered you it'd be wiht the first or second one [the full sentences]".

[14:30]: Using Davis (2026: 84) which defines *=aa* as a sentence level enclitic, acting as a polar marker. Apparently, for neturel questions *nee* is used alongside *=aa*, but Hector seems fine with the translating the question with simply *=aa*?

(42) gilbil smex gya'anaa
gilbil smex gya'a-n=aa
two bear see-2SG.II=Q
'Did you see two bears?'

[16:20]:

(43) a. guphl smexhl maa'y
gup=hl smex=hl maa'y
eat=CN bear=CN berries
'The bear(s) ate berries'

b. yukwhl guphl smex maa'y
yukw=hl gup=hl smex=hl maa'y
PROG=CN eat=CN bear=CN berries
'The bear(s) are eating berries'

c. yukwhl gipguphl smex maa'y
yukw=hl gip∼gup=hl smex=hl maa'y
PROG=CN PL∼eat=CN bear=CN berries
'The bear(s) are eating the berries'

[17:40]: Now this is interesting. Davis (2026: 80) shows that *an* is the A-extraction marker, moreover, fn. 86 says that HH frequently deletes *=t*, exactly what we see in the second example.

What's fascinating is that we have what should be the head [*gilbil smex*] separated from the RC [*an guphl maa'y*] by the matrix verb *gya'ay*. It seems that this strongly supports a movement analysis of [*gilbil smex*] to a pre-predicative position.

Note that Hector first says the sentence without *an*, but it feels like he corrects himself later since he is saying it while processing, so I will tentatively assume that *an* is still necessary in this construction.

Hello it's me from future: Apparently this isn't crazy since it is still ambiguous; both focus fronting and a headless RC would show the same morphology.

(44) bag̲adil/gilbil smex gya'ay an guphl maa'y
bag̲adil/gilbil smex gya'a-y an gup=hl maa'y
HUM.two/two bear see-2SG.II AX eat=CN berries
'I seen two bears eating berries'

[20:22]: "It's almost out of place, but it's understandable that you've seen two bears eating berries". If using *gipguphl* it means a lot of berries.

(45) ?? gilbil smex an guphl maa'y gya'ay
gilbil smex an gup=hl maa'y gya'a-y
two bear AX eat=CN berries see-2SG.II
Intended: 'I saw two bears eating berries'

[20:49]: In response to above, Hector offers this.

(46) gya'ay gilbil smex an guphl maa'y
gya'a-y gilbil smex an gup=hl maa'y
see-2SG.II two bear AX eat=CN berries
'I saw two bears eating berries'

[21:16]: I think I hear the attributive *-m* after *sg̲an*.

(47) sg̲anim maa'y
sg̲an-m maa'y
bush-ATTR berries
'bush/branch of berries'

[21:35]: I swear I don't hear [=hl] here lol.

(48) miiluxw[=hl] bag̲adil hanaak̲'
miiluxw[=hl] bag̲adil hanaak̲'
dance[=CN] two.HUM woman.PL
'Two women danced'

[23:52] + [24:59]:

(49) gilbilhl/bag̲adil hanaak̲' miiluxwit
gilbil=hl/bag̲adil hanaak̲' miiluxw-t
two.HUM/two=CN woman.PL dance-3SG.II
'Two women danced'

[24:09]:

(50) yukwhl miiluxw=hl bag̲adil hanaak̲'
yukw=hl miiluxw=hl bag̲adil hanaak̲'
PROG=CN dance=CN two.HUM woman.PL
'Two women are dancing'

[24:44] + [25:25]:: Both readings don't seem to work.

(51) * bag̲adil miiluxwhl hanaak̲'
bag̲adil miiluxw=hl hanaak̲'
two.HUM woman.PL dance=CN
Intended: 'Two women danced' / 'Women danced twice'

[25:30]: Unsure if *he'ksimux* 'again' can be decomposed! Comment: "They stop/sit down and they begin again."

(52) he'ksimux miiluxwhl bag̲adil hanaak̲'
he'ksimux miiluxw=hl bag̲adil hanaak̲'
again dance=CN two.HUM woman.PL
'Two women danced again'

[26:25]:

(53) hilthl smex sapag̲ayt g̲an
hilt=hl smex sapag̲ayt g̲an
many=CN bear amongst tree
'There are many bears in the forest.'

[26:53]: Hector didn't confirm this, but didn't reject it either? In response Hector mentioned *hiltdaya* (or something analagous) may be used as a response? To be like "oh, there are many?".

For Michael: if *=aa* combines with *hilda*, do we get palatilization as in *hildaya*?

(54) gya'a'yhl hilda smex
hilt=hl smex sapag̲ayt g̲an
many=CN bear amongst tree
'There are many bears in the forest.'

[27:38]: Apparently there are other words for 'many' that Hector hears when he goes home, but he doesn't use them.

(55) hilthl smex gya'a'y
hilt=hl smex gya'a-'y
many=CN bear see-1SG.II
'I saw many bears.'

[28:40]: Don't really hear a *=hl* after *silkw*. Is it there underlyingly?

(56) silkw g̲abiihl smex gya'a'y
silkw g̲abii=hl smex gya'a-'y
amazing CNT.AMT=CN bear see-1SG.II
'I saw a lot [=an amazing amount] of bears.'

[29:40]: "There has to be something else to complete that [=the utterance]". I'm guessing it's ungrammatical? I have a suspicion that *g̲abiihl* is doing some funky stuff, since otherwise weak quantifiers are attested post-predicatively?

(57) * gya'a'y silkw g̲abiihl smex
gya'a-'y silkw g̲abii=hl smex
see-1SG.II amazing= CNT.AMT=CN bear
'I saw a lot [=an amazing amount] of bears.'

[30:48]: Not sure if this is a full sentence

(58) silkw wildit
silkw wild-t
amazing do-3SG.II
'He/she did something bad (unsure)'

[30:50]: I don't really know the status of a. below and why Hector first said it with *g̲abihl*... Totally possible that it has a use case here, but idk what it is.

(59) a. gya'a'y g̲abiihl win silkw wilhl smex
gya'a-'y g̲abii=hl win silkw wilt=hl smex
see-1SG.II CNT.AMT=CN COMP amazing do-CN bear
'Possibly: I saw how bad the bears act.'

b. gya'a'y win silkw wilhl smex
gya'a-'y win silkw wilt=hl smex
see-1SG.II COMP amazing do-CN bear
'I saw how bad the bears act.'

[32:25]: Again, in response we can say something like "hilhiltaya" was is a lot?

(60) hilthl smex gya'a'y an guphl maa'y
hilt=hl smex gya'a-'y an[-t] gup=hl maa'y
many=CN bear see-1SG.II SX[-3SG.II] eat=Cn berries
'I saw many bears eating berries.'

[33:55]: "It's broken, got to put gya'a'y in the beginning."

(61) * hilthl smex an guphl maa'y gya'a'y
hilt=hl smex an[-t] gup=hl maa'y gya'a-'y
many=CN bear SX[-3SG.II] eat=Cn berries see-1SG.II
Intended: 'I saw many bears eating berries.'

[34:29]: Not 100% on this because it was a bit broken up, so not the best-elicited sentence by me. But likely better than the above.

(62) gya'a'y hilthl smex an guphl maa'y
gya'a-'y hilt=hl smex an[-t] gup=hl maa'y
see-1SG.II many=CN bear SX[-3SG.II] eat=Cn berries
Intended: 'I saw many bears eating berries.'

2.2 Zahra [35:00-60:00]

[35:50]:

[]: hilthl t'uuts'xw-m smex (g'a'ay) loot
Lots of black bears there.

[]: (yukw) wok=hl ['wii t'uuts'xw-it smex] / (k'yoots)
sleep=CN big black-SX bear
The big black bear is sleeping.

[]: (ga'a'y) / (yukw) hadiks=hl ['wii t'uuts'xw-m smex] (k'yoots)
swim=CN big black-SX bear
The big black bear is swimming.

[]: t'uuts'xw-m smex hadiks-it
black-ATTR bear swim-SX
The bear that is swimming is black.
"If the other brown bear or the black bear is still standing."

[]: t'uuts'xw=hl smex wok-it
black=CN bear sleep-SX
The bear that is sleeping is black.

[]: gya'a'y=hl hild-a hun
see-1SG.II=CN many-ATTR fish
I saw many fish.
→ Answers a question, somewhere where there's no fish, no water. You're telling a story. Might be surprising that I saw them.

[]: hild-a gya'a'y=hl hun
many-ATTR see-1SG.II=CN fish
I saw fish many times.

[53:50]:

(63) jehl-?=hl Gitanyow Kispiox
beat-?=hl Gitanyow Kispiox
'Gitanyow beat [=made lose] Kispiox.' [causative obscured by connective?]

[54:00]:

(64) yukwhl hlithl Kispiox gan Gitanyow 'ii jehl Kispiox.
PROG soccer Kispiox and Gitanyow and lose Kispiox
'Kispiox and Gitanyow were playing soccer, and Kispiox lost.'.

hlit 'soccer'. *xsdaa* 'win'.

(65) k'i'y win jehl Kispiox[hl ?] Gitanyow.
one COMP lose Kispiox Gitanyow
'Kispiox lost by one from Gitanyow'.

(66) gwile'l[] win xsdaahl Gitanyow 'ii k̲'am gilbil jephl Kispiox.
three COMP win[=score] Gitanyow and only two make Kispiox
'Gitanyow scored three times and Kispiox only scored twice'.

References

Davis, Henry. 2026. The Morphosyntax of Gitksan: A Grammatical Sketch with Examples from ‘Nit Gan Wilt.